ENTRANCE ANTIPHON

If you, O Lord, should mark iniquities, Lord, who could stand? But with you is found forgiveness, O God of Israel.

PENITENTIAL RITE

You were sent to heal the contrite of heart:
Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

You came to call sinners:
Christ, have mercy. Christ, have mercy.

You are seated at the right hand of the Father to intercede for us:
Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy.

May almighty God have mercy on us.....Amen.

THE GLORIA

**Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.
We praise you, we bless you,
we adore you, we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.
Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father
you take away the sins of the world:
have mercy on us;
you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer; you are seated
at the right hand of the Father
have mercy on us;
For you alone are the Holy One,
you alone are the Lord,
you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit,
in the glory of God the Father. Amen.**



OPENING PRAYER

May your grace, O Lord, we pray, at all times go before us and follow after and make us always determined to carry out good works.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ,.....

LITURGY OF THE WORD

FIRST READING *Isaiah 25: 6 - 10*

A reading from the prophet of Isaiah.

On this mountain,
the Lord of hosts will prepare for all people
a banquet of rich food, a banquet of fine
wines, of food rich and juicy,
of fine strained wines.
On this mountain he will remove
the mourning veil covering all peoples,
and the shroud enwrapping all nations,
he will destroy Death for ever.
The Lord will wipe away
the tears from every cheek;
he will take away his people's shame
everywhere on earth,
for the Lord has said so.
That day, it will be said:
See, this is our God
in whom we hoped for salvation;
the Lord is the one in whom we hoped.
We exult and we rejoice that he has saved us; for the hand of the Lord
rests on this mountain.

The word of the Lord. ***Thanks be to God.***



RESPONSORIAL PSALM *Ps.22*

R. In the Lord's own house shall I dwell for ever and ever.

1. The Lord is my shepherd;
there is nothing I shall want.
Fresh and green are the pastures
where he gives me repose.
Near restful waters he leads me,
to revive my drooping spirit. *(R)*

2. He guides me along the right path;
he is true to his name.
If I should walk in the valley of darkness
no evil would I fear.
You are there with your crook and your staff;
with these you give me comfort. *(R)*

3. You have prepared a banquet for me
in the sight of my foes.
My head you have anointed with oil;
my cup is overflowing. *(R)*

4. Surely goodness and kindness shall
follow me all the days of my life.
In the Lord's own house shall I dwell
for ever and ever. *(R)*

SECOND READING *Philippians 4:12-14. 19-20*

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Philippians

I know how to be poor and I know how to be rich too. I have been through my initiation and now I am ready for anything anywhere: full stomach or empty stomach, poverty or plenty. There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength. All the same, it was good of you to share with me in my hardships. In return my God will fulfil all your needs, in Christ Jesus, as lavishly as only God can. Glory to God, our Father, for ever and ever. Amen.

The word of the Lord. ***Thanks be to God.***

GOSPEL ACCLAMATION

Alleluia, alleluia! The Word was made flesh and lived among us; to all who did accept him he gave power to become children of God. Alleluia!

GOSPEL *Matthew 22: 1-14 (*shorter form 22:1-10)*

A reading from the holy Gospel according to Matthew.

Jesus said to the chief priests and elders of the people: 'The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a feast for his son's wedding. He sent his servants to call those who had been invited, but they would not come. Next he sent some more servants. "Tell those who have been invited" he said "that I have my banquet all prepared, my oxen and fattened cattle have been slaughtered, everything is ready. Come to the wedding." But they were not interested: one went off to his farm, another to his business, and the rest seized his servants, maltreated them and killed them. The king was furious. He despatched his troops, destroyed those murderers and burnt their town. Then he said to his servants, "The wedding is ready; but as those who were invited proved to be unworthy, go to the crossroads in the town and invite everyone you can find to the wedding." So these servants went out on to the roads and collected together everyone they could find, bad and good alike; and the wedding hall was filled with guests. When the king came in to look at the guests he noticed one man who was not wearing a wedding garment, and said to him, "How did you get in here, my friend, without a wedding garment?" And the man was silent. Then the king said to the attendants, "Bind him hand and foot and throw him out into the dark, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth." For many are called, but few are chosen.'

The Gospel of the Lord.
Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

APOSTLES' CREED

**I believe in God, the Father almighty,
Creator of heaven and earth,
and in Jesus Christ,
his only Son, our Lord,**

All bow for following two lines:

**who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died and was buried;
he descended into hell;
on the third day he rose again
from the dead; he ascended into heaven,
and is seated at the right hand of God,
the Father almighty;
from there he will come to judge
the living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.**

LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

AFTER THE CONSECRATION

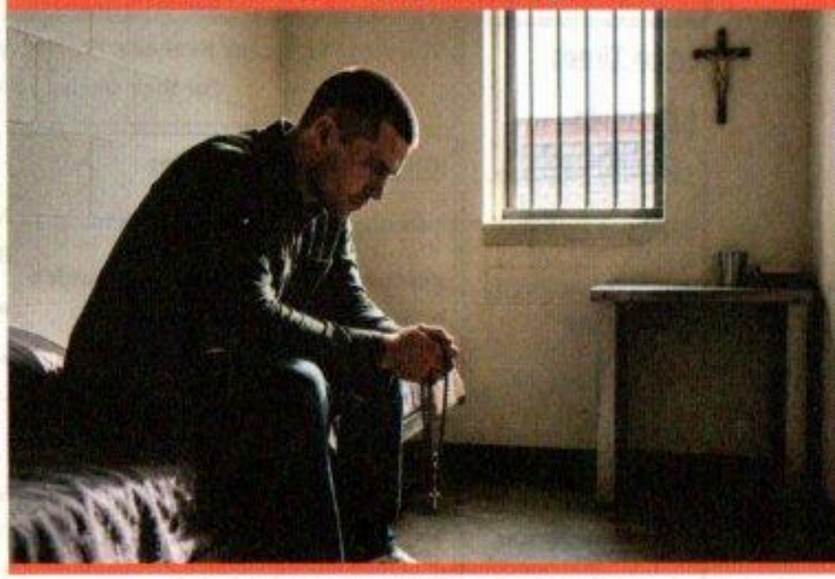
The mystery of faith.
We proclaim your Death, O Lord, and profess your Resurrection until you come again.

focus on sunday

TWENTY-EIGHTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME 11th October 2026 Year A

Prisoners Sunday

God is generous to his people; his is the gift of life and love, of reconciliation and of justice. He expects us to be generous in return so that others may know his generosity.



Today is prisoner Sunday and the Church asks us to reflect on this most marginalised and often despised section of our population. Many accept, without reflection, that our prisons are full of dangerous, violent criminals. While there are certainly some dangerous people in prison, 80% of those convicted are sentenced to 12 months or less, suggesting that their crimes are less serious (accepting that even less serious crimes can be upsetting or even traumatic for the victim). 70% of prisoners have an addiction but our addiction services have long waiting lists.

The Government plan to provide 1,500 extra prison places to combat the overcrowding in our prisons, but it might actually be more effective to provide 1,500 extra drug treatment places. 70% have mental health issues and our mental health services are generally recognised as very inadequate. Our prisons are overcrowded, full of drugs and increasingly violent places, making rehabilitation almost impossible. Some are on remand with bail set at €50 or €100, but they haven't got it, so they remain in prison simply because they are poor. Others have bail, but because they cannot provide an address, they remain in prison because they are homeless. Most people who commit crime grow out of it. Many tell me that they gave up crime because they fell in love, or had a child, or found employment, and that now they have a reason, for the first time in their lives, not to go to jail. Perhaps it is the system, just as much as prisoners, which needs rehabilitation!

Fr. Peter McVerry SJ

Liturgical texts: concordat cum originali: © Dermot Farrell, Archbishop of Dublin Other texts: cum permissu: © Dermot Farrell, Archbishop of Dublin. Excerpts from the English translation of the Roman Missal, © 2010 International Committee on English in the Liturgy Corporation. All rights reserved. Used with permission. The Jerusalem version of the Scriptures is copyright Darton, Longman & Todd & Doubleday & Co. Inc. Responsorial psalms are copyright The Grail & or Geoffrey Chapman Ltd. Published by Logos Publications. 25 Tolka Valley Business Park, Ballyboggan Rd, Glasnevin, D11 WK08 Phone (01 830 6751)

PARISH CENTRE: 22229/22779; CATHEDRAL PRESBYTERY: 22505
BÓTHAR NA NAOMH PRESBYTERY: 22688.
PARISH CENTRE MOBILE NUMBER: 085 8819575
WEBSITE: www.thurlesparish.ie **email:** parishcentre@thurlesparish.ie

THURLES PARISH MASS TIMES:
WEEKENDS: Cathedral: Saturday Vigil 7.00 p.m., Sunday 11.00 a.m.
Bóthar na Naomh Church: Sunday 09.30 a.m. & 7.00 p.m.
WEEKDAYS: Cathedral: Monday - Friday: 11.00 a.m.
Bóthar na Naomh: Tuesday & Thursday 7.00 p.m. Saturday: 11.00 a.m.
FOR OUR STREAMING SERVICE ON-LINE visit www.thurlesparish.ie.

CATHEDRAL OF THE ASSUMPTION: "RAISE THE ROOF"
LOTTO INITIATIVE
Weekly Lotto Draw Results Oct 8th:
Winning Numbers 4; 7; 8; 12. The Jackpot was not won.
Cash Prize of €50 to the weekly winner – John O'Donovan, Thurles.
Next Draw: October 15th - Jackpot: €11,350.
We are deeply grateful to all who have supported to date our fundraising drive for the Cathedral Reroofing Project –- We are delighted to inform you that we now have exceeded 1.8 million!! A big *Míle Buíochas* to all who are supporting this project.
The lotto has assisted immensely in reaching the **€1.8** million of the **€2.5** million required for us to commence the Reroofing of our Cathedral. Thank you!!

'IN OUR HANDS: PRESERVING OUR CATHEDRAL'
Having now commenced Phase 2 of our fundraising campaign which we hope will get us to the magic figure of €2.5 million. ***"In Our Hands: Preserving Our Cathedral"*** is a fundraising campaign that we hope will encourage people, near and far, to support the reroofing project by donating towards the cost of the slates. Our objective is to have all the necessary works to this magnificent building completed in time for the 150th anniversary of the Cathedral's construction in 2029. You can purchase a slate or a bundle of 4 – a symbolic and practical way to help reroof the Cathedral. *Let us preserve our sacred Cathedral, protect its rich history and ensure it continues to inspire for generations to come! Visit www.inourhandsthurles.ie for more information.*

WEEKLY ENVELOPE CONTRIBUTION: We are very grateful for your Weekly Offertory Contributions - **€3,640.00** received.

OCTOBER CLERGY COLLLECTION: Sincere thanks to all who contributed to this Collection last weekend. Jim & Vincent say "*thank you"* for your continued support on behalf of the Priests of the Archdiocese.

FAMILY MASS: First Family Mass for the new year - Sat 10th Oct @ 7.00 p.m. in the Cathedral. Theme: All are invited!

THE CHOSEN: Join us for Season 5 of the award-winning mini-series on the life of Jesus. Season 5 documents the events of Easter Week and especially the Last Supper. A great opportunity to deepen your faith with time for prayer and conversation. Come along and join us in Lámh Chúnta, Monday October 12th at 7.30 p.m.

THURLES YOUNG ADULT PRAYER: See the upcoming dates for our prayer group (open to 18-35 year olds) which meets in Bóthar na Naomh Church twice a month on Fridays @ 8pm. Prayer, Adoration, Scripture and friendship with other young people interested in their faith. All are welcome.

ADORATION FOR YOUTH: Tuesday Oct. 20th in Bóthar na Naomh Church commencing with Mass at 7.00 pm. Followed by Adoration until 10 p.m. Come and pray for this intention.

MISSION SUNDAY 11.00 A.M. MASS:
The 11.00 a.m. Mass on Mission Sunday, October 18th will be broadcast live by R.T.E. in the Cathedral. Archbishop Kieran O'Reilly will celebrate the Mass. Come along and join us in the Cathedral on Mission Sunday.
Annual Missions Collection Envelopes available at the back of both Churches.
Please Note: Due to preparation for the Mission Sunday Mass there will be NO EUCHARISTIC ADORATION on Saturday, October 17th.

POPE JOHN PAUL II AWARD - CALLING ALL 16–18-YEAR-OLDS: Get active, get involved and make a difference in your local parish and school community through the **Pope John Paul II Award**. This is a wonderful opportunity to meet others, develop your skills and put your faith into action. To find out more or take part locally, contact your parish priest or Fiona, Youth Coordinator, at **youth@cashel-emly.ie**. Applications close on **31 October**.

GOD WITH ST. FRANCIS: Evening of faith, music and reflection inspired by the life of St. Francis of Assisi on Friday 16th October at 7.30 pm in St Michael's Church, Tipperary Town. Through Scripture, prayer, reflection and Christian music, the parish with **James Kilbane, Gospel Singer,** will help lead this special parish evening. Free parish service with a free will offering collection to help with expenses**.** All welcome.

URSULINE SECONDARY SCHOOL: Presents Les Miserables. Saturday, October 17, Sunday, October 18, Tuesday, October 20 & Thursday, October 22 - nightly at 8pm. Tickets on Gr8events.ie

ONE FLEW OVER THE CUCKOO'S NEST": Thurles Drama Group are staging One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest in The Source Theatre commencing on **Monday 16th November**. The proceeds from the first night of the production on Monday,16th November are being donated to Thurles Lions Club who have committed to raising a minimum of €50,000 towards the Cathedral of the Assumption Reroofing Fund. Tickets are **€20** each and include a pre-show finger food reception at 7.15 pm. Tickets available from The Parish Office or Thurles Lions Club members.

PREVENTION & MANAGEMENT OF LYMPHOEDEMA: Suir Haven Cancer Support Centre, Monday 12th Oct., 6.30pm All are welcome. Information: Tricia on 0876509494.

THURLES DISTRICT FLOWER CLUB: Next Meeting Tuesday, October 13th, Order of Malta Hall, 8.00 p.m. Garden Talk by Niall Tuohy, Ardmayle. Non-members welcome. Admission: €10 including refreshments.

CIRCLING THE SQUARE POETRY FESTIVAL: October 16th – 18th. **Fri. 7.30p.m. Bookworm:** Opening & poetry. **Sat. 2.30 p.m. Source Arts Centre:** Panel with **Fintan O'Toole, Declan O'Driscoll & Mick Heaney**, followed by poetry/music; The **Source 7.45 p.m.** Evening event honouring Thurles-born poet, the late **Dennis O'Driscoll**. **Sun. 11am, Stanwix Village:** Heritage walk. **2pm, Monks Pub:** Open mic. **All welcome.**

NEWLY BAPTISED: *John William Butler, Rahealty. *Alfie Tom Miller Ryan, Mill Road.

RECENTLY DECEASED: ✞Paddy Kelly, Leugh.

SAFEGUARDING MONTH IS OCTOBER: CREATING A SAFE PARISH:

A safe parish is one where children and young people are cherished, listened to and protected. Our safeguarding policies, training and procedures help us to provide safe environments for everyone involved in parish activities. We are grateful to our Parish Safeguarding Representatives, clergy, staff and volunteers for their continued commitment to this important work.

Please note Safeguarding Representatives will speak at the following Masses next weekend, October 17th/18th: Cathedral: Saturday Vigil Mass 7.00 p.m.; Bóthar na Naomh Church: Sunday 9.30 a.m. & 7.00 p.m.

"It cannot be emphasised enough how everything is interconnected. Just as the different aspects of the planet ----physical, chemical, are interrelated, so too living species are part of a network which we will never fully explore or understand." *Laudato Si*